The Ayesha Morning

Monday, 12 October 2026 BACKFILLED EDITION 12 stories · 12 sources

1 source articles could not be read today; those stories show headlines and links only.

THREE THINGS TO KNOW

1. CapBay commended the RM270 million co-investment allocation and extended stamp duty relief for P2P financing announced in Budget 2027.
2. Apple disclosed an agreement to hire staff and license IP from the personalized audio startup Huxe, which recently ceased operations.
3. The Trump administration hosted tech executives at the White House to sign a voluntary safety pact that leaves AI regulation largely to the industry.

CapBay Welcomes Budget 2027 Co-Investment Funds and Stamp Duty Relief

Fintech platform CapBay commended the RM270 million co-investment allocation and extended stamp duty relief for P2P financing announced in Budget 2027.

- Malaysia allocated an additional RM270 million in co-investment funds under Budget 2027 to mobilize private investment via P2P and equity crowdfunding platforms. [thestar.com.my]

  > "MyCIF has demonstrated how government funding can bring private investors alongside it to support businesses."

- The government proposed extending the RM10 stamp duty relief on P2P financing agreements through December 31, 2030. [thestar.com.my]

  > "helps keep financing costs manageable for SMEs while providing greater certainty for businesses and platform operators."

- Alternative financing avenues raised RM5.7 billion for MSMEs and mid-tier companies in 2025, marking significant annual growth. [thestar.com.my]

  > "According to the SC Annual Report 2025, alternative financing avenues raised RM5.7bil for MSMEs and mid-tier companies in 2025, a year-on-year increase of 39%."

- Budget 2027 provides up to RM1 billion in financing through Teraju, with CapBay offering Shariah-compliant financing as a partner. [thestar.com.my]

  > "Budget 2027 also provides up to RM1bil in financing through Teraju as part of its support for Bumiputera contractors and businesses."

In the image: A smiling man in a dark blazer and white undershirt stands before a backdrop displaying the phrases 'SME Financing' and 'P2P Investing'.

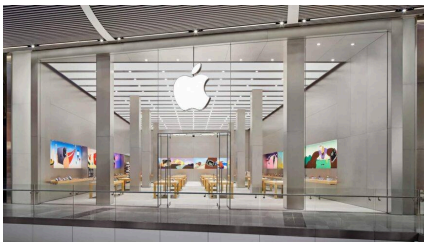
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thestar.com.my

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STARTUPS AND VENTURE CAPITAL



Apple Licenses Technology and Hires Talent From Shut-Down Startup Huxe

Apple has disclosed an agreement to hire staff and license IP from the personalized audio startup Huxe, which recently ceased operations.

- Apple disclosed a deal to hire staff and license IP from Huxe AI, a personalized audio startup that shut down. [foreignpolicyjournal.com]

  > "Apple (NASDAQ: AAPL) has disclosed a deal to bring on staff and license intellectual property from Huxe AI, a personalized audio startup that recently shut down its operations."

- The transaction was revealed via a regulatory filing with the European Commission.

  [foreignpolicyjournal.com]

  > "The agreement, which Apple revealed through a regulatory filing with the European Commission, involves making employment offers to certain Huxe AI team members"

- Huxe was founded by former developers of AI podcast features in Google's NotebookLM.

  [foreignpolicyjournal.com]

  > "Huxe was founded by developers who previously worked on the AI-generated podcast features inside NotebookLM"

- Huxe announced its shutdown and the removal of its app on May 21.

  [foreignpolicyjournal.com]

  > "The startup announced on May 21 that it was shutting down, with the team confirming it would remove its app from both the Apple and Google stores"

In the image: The image shows the exterior storefront of an Apple retail store, which is not mentioned in the text.

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foreignpolicyjournal.com

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Woman Regrets Rejecting High-Paying London Startup Job After Huge Funding Round

A woman reflects on her past decision to turn down a lucrative job offer in London after seeing the startup raise millions.

- A woman expressed regret over a past career decision after a London startup she rejected raised a massive funding round.

  [moneycontrol.com]

  > "What if I had taken that job?': Woman reflects on rejecting Rs 77 lakh London startup offer after company raises Rs 38 crore"

In the image: The image illustrates the woman's contrasting thoughts between traveling or living in London and growing with a successful corporate startup team.

✓ 1 of 1 claims verified against sources · 1 source

moneycontrol.com

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New Tech Innovations Range From Smart Pianos to Ultra-Thin SSDs

Recent tech releases highlight innovative products designed to solve specific problems in storage, portability, and smart device integration.

- Roland announced its first digital piano with onboard Wi-Fi, the FP-40, which automatically updates software and records playing history without opening apps. [slashgear.com]

  > “In September 2026, Roland announced its first digital piano with onboard Wi-Fi, the FP-40.”

- Lexar introduced the thin Muse portable SSD featuring magnetic PogoPin-to-USB-C connections designed for use with smartphones. [slashgear.com]

  > “Lexar takes on the challenge of supporting creators on the go with the world's thinnest portable SSD.”

- BenQ announced its iMac-focused iScreenBar featuring radar motion sensing and automatic lighting adjustments for video calls. [slashgear.com]

  > “In August 2026, BenQ announced its iMac-focused iScreenBar, which took home the Red Dot Design Award”

In the image: The image shows a backpack, laptop, tablet, smartphone, portable hard drive, and headphones, representing mobile tech gear that the text discusses.

✓ 3 of 3 claims verified against sources · 1 source

slashgear.com

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Texas Tech University Announces Free Application Week for Prospective Students

Texas Tech is waiving application fees for undergraduate and graduate programs from October 12-18 as part of a statewide initiative.

- Texas Tech University is expanding its participation in Texas Free College Application Week to include both undergraduate and graduate programs. [kcbd.com]

  > "Texas Tech University is expanding its participation in Texas Free College Application Week, giving more prospective students the opportunity to apply for undergraduate and graduate programs without paying an application fee."

- The free application period runs from October 12 through October 18 for eligible programs. [kcbd.com]

  > "From Oct. 12-18, Texas residents can apply to eligible undergraduate programs at Texas Tech for free through ApplyTexas as part of the statewide initiative coordinated by the Texas Higher Education Coordinating Board."

- Current Texas Tech undergraduates can also apply to the Graduate School for free regardless of residency. [kcbd.com]

  > "Current Texas Tech undergraduate students can also apply to the Graduate School for free during the week, regardless of their state of residency."

- Online accelerated eight-week programs and Law School applications remain free of charge. [kcbd.com]

  > "Texas Tech's Online's accelerated eight-week programs are not dependent on the promotion; applications to those programs are free."

In the image: The image displays the Texas Tech University double T athletic logo in red, black, and white.

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kcbd.com

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Trump administration backs self-policing for artificial intelligence industry

President Donald Trump hosted tech executives at the White House to sign a voluntary safety pact that leaves AI regulation largely to the industry.

- The 308-word agreement asks advanced AI labs to set up internal teams to monitor safety protocols rather than relying on hard laws.

  [nvdaily.com]

  > "The 308-word agreement lays out that advanced AI labs should follow safety protocols and set up internal teams to monitor their own progress"

- Critics and former safety researchers have expressed concern that relying on self-policing is insufficient for addressing serious near-term AI safety risks.

  [nvdaily.com]

  > "This is no substitute for hard law, and it does give a lot of freedom to the companies"

- Representatives from major companies including OpenAI, Anthropic, Meta, Google, SpaceXAI, and Nvidia signed the document.

  [nvdaily.com]

  > "The document was signed by representatives of OpenAI, Anthropic, Meta, Google, SpaceXAI and Nvidia."

In the image: The image shows President Donald Trump seated at a long conference table surrounded by prominent tech executives and

industry leaders in a White House setting.

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nvdaily.com

You engaged with 1 of 2 Technology industry stories you saw

Financial Comparison: Zebra Technologies Versus Astrotech

A financial comparison of technology companies Astrotech and Zebra Technologies reveals major differences in revenue, earnings, risk, and analyst recommendations.

- Astrotech exhibits significantly higher stock price volatility than Zebra Technologies. [dailypolitical.com]

  > "Astrotech has a beta of 4.91, meaning that its stock price is 391% more volatile than the S&P 500."

- Zebra Technologies significantly outperforms Astrotech in terms of gross revenue and net income. [dailypolitical.com]

  > "Zebra Technologies has higher revenue and earnings than Astrotech."

- Institutional ownership is much higher for Zebra Technologies than for Astrotech. [dailypolitical.com]

  > "91.0% of Zebra Technologies shares are owned by institutional investors."

- Overall, Zebra Technologies leads in the majority of compared financial and market metrics. [dailypolitical.com]

  > "Zebra Technologies beats Astrotech on 11 of the 14 factors compared between the two stocks."

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dailypolitical.com

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Tech Archives < All India Roundup

allindiaroundup.com

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Silicon Valley Tech Week Revels in AI Boom Amid Bubble Fears

Attendees at San Francisco Tech Week celebrate an AI gold rush while privately questioning its long-term sustainability.

- San Francisco Tech Week features a variety of events, including panel discussions, cold plunges in the bay, and unique networking activities. [ksmu.org]

  > "And the events range from panel discussions with company founders to early morning cold plunges in the San Francisco Bay."

- Venture capitalist Drew Glover notes that artificial intelligence has sparked a major boom and revolution across new businesses. [ksmu.org]

  > "AI's created a boom and a revolution that I think is really exciting."

- Despite widespread enthusiasm, startup employee Capri Wheaton expresses concerns about whether the current AI momentum is sustainable or merely a bubble. [ksmu.org]

  > "is this an AI bubble? How long is all this momentum and hype going to last for? Is this all sustainable?"

- Software engineer Brian Hoang expresses uncertainty about job security, suggesting that traditional coding might soon become obsolete due to AI. [ksmu.org]

  > "Coding itself, like writing out code - it might be dead."

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ksmu.org

You engaged with 0 of 3 Artificial intelligence stories you saw

China Has Already Established Extensive Artificial Intelligence Rules and Governance

While US tech leaders urge new regulations to manage advanced artificial intelligence, China has already implemented a robust and evolving framework of oversight.

- Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei and other American tech leaders have called for government intervention and independent evaluation to manage the dangers of advanced artificial intelligence. [independent.co.ug]

  > "Dario Amodei, chief executive of tech company Anthropic, has called for governments to intervene to slow the development of increasingly powerful AI models."

- China introduced rules in 2022 that regulate algorithmic recommendation services and compel companies to protect user information and introduce safeguards for various populations. [independent.co.ug]

  > "Beijing's 2022 rules on algorithmic recommendation services apply to technologies that select, rank, filter or recommend online content to users."

- China's deep synthesis provisions, which took effect in January 2023, extended regulations to cover synthetic text, images,

audio, and video.

[independent.co.ug]

> “China’s deep synthesis provisions, effective from January 2023, extended regulation to synthetic (or AI-generated) text, images, audio and video.”

- Beijing published its AI safety governance framework 3.0 in September 2026 to identify, grade, and respond to risks throughout the lifecycle of AI systems.

[independent.co.ug]

> “Beijing’s latest set of measures is called the AI safety governance framework 3.0, published in September 2026.”

In the image: A portrait of Madeline Carr, the author of the commentary.

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independent.co.ug

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ENVIRONMENT



Three Oxfordshire projects commended in CPRE biodiversity awards

Three regional projects have been highly commended in a major biodiversity awards scheme celebrating wildlife-friendly gardening and habitat creation.

- Three Oxfordshire projects were highly commended in the CPRE Centenary Biodiversity Award scheme. [witneygazette.co.uk]

  > “Three Oxfordshire projects have been highly commended in a major biodiversity awards scheme”

- The Greener Henley project was recognized for its 'Nature Squared' initiative aiming to create connected pollinator habitats. [witneygazette.co.uk]

  > “Greener Henley was commended for its flagship 'Nature Squared' project, which encourages residents and organisations to plant one square metre of space for pollinators”

- Mill Lane Community Garden in Chinnor was praised for featuring pollinator-friendly flower beds and wildlife habitats. [witneygazette.co.uk]

  > “The garden, built on land originally rejected by the developer, features pollinator-friendly flower beds, native planting, and wildlife habitats”

- Uffington Community Garden was noted as an accessible welcoming place for people to learn about growing food regardless of experience. [witneygazette.co.uk]

  > “The garden was designed as a place for the whole community to learn about growing fruit and vegetables, regardless of experience”

In the image: The image shows three people holding the CPRE Centenary Biodiversity Award trophy at a presentation ceremony.

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witneygazette.co.uk

Exploring: a Environment story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more



Verstappen on Pole for Singapore Grand Prix as Ferrari Pursues

Max Verstappen starts on pole in Singapore, but pressure from Ferrari, wet weather threats, and strategic challenges loom large at the Marina Bay Circuit.

- Max Verstappen has secured pole position for the Singapore Grand Prix on the Marina Bay Circuit. [grandprix247.com]

  > “Max Verstappen is on pole for the Singapore Grand Prix, exactly where he needs to be on the narrow, twisting Marina Bay Circuit.”

- Isack Hadjar experienced a mechanical issue during qualifying that left him out of contention. [grandprix247.com]

  > “Isack Hadjar suffered a mechanical failure, putting him out of contention in qualifying.”

- George Russell incurred a 40-place penalty for engine changes following a difficult sprint race. [grandprix247.com]

  > “After bottling the Sprint by spinning from the lead, George Russell has now taken a 40-place penalty for engine changes.”

In the image: The image shows the complete starting grid lineup and driver numbers for the Singapore Grand Prix against a nighttime city backdrop.

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grandprix247.com

Exploring: a Motorsport story outside your usual topics, to learn whether you want more

You're caught up.

That's today's paper. Your next edition arrives tomorrow morning.